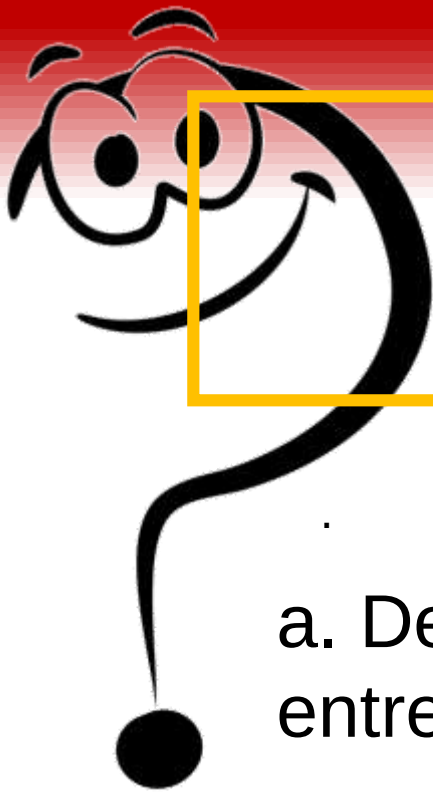


Describe *Philippine Cultural Values* And Entrepreneurship



LESSON 3



BIG PICTURE B

Unit Learning Outcomes

- a. Describe Philippine cultural values and entrepreneurship
- b. Explain the ethics and the social and legal responsibilities of entrepreneurs



METALANGUAGE

1. **Cultural Values.** The ideals held by a community as standards for social or interpersonal behavior.
2. **Attitudes.** The way one sees things, persons, events, and circumstances.
3. **Behavior.** This is also referred as practices. This refers to how people respond under certain situations.



FILIPINO VALUES FAVORABLE TO ENTREPRENEURSHIP

1. Pakikipagkapwa. This trait is about how a person treats and relate with the people around him. This also encompasses the following.

- i. concern for hiya (loss of face)
- ii. pakikisama (togetherness or companionship)
- iii. pakikibagay (adjusting or adapting to other people)
- iv. pagmamalasakit (concern)
- v. utang na loob (sense of gratitude)
- vi. amor propio (self-esteem)
- vii. bayanihan (cooperative spirit)



Pakikipagkapwa

- **Pakikipagkapwa** promotes the ideals of entrepreneurship because the person's main concern is providing better products and services so that he may not experience loss of face (hiya).
- The **togetherness or companionship (pakikisama)** practice improves the entrepreneur's network and the reach of his business. The person's ability to adjust or adapt to other people's ways will also help the entrepreneur provide more relevant products and services as he could understand the needs and wants of these targets.
- Moreover, the **concern (malasakit)** of a Filipino is also helpful in his entrepreneurial endeavors as this will push him to go the extra mile in order to provide services and products to his customers. The customers often have different needs and an extra touch will make customers delighted.
- Furthermore, **the sense of gratitude (utang na loob)** will often make an entrepreneur look back and offer social responsibility projects. In addition, a Filipino with high self-esteem often attracts more customers to trust in his displayed confidence.
- Lastly, the **cooperative spirit (bayanihan)** of Filipinos is essential in his entrepreneurial activities as this will make him more involved with his community and strengthen his ties with his current target market.



2. Risk-taking (*Lakas ng Loob*). This trait is about pursuing a business without 100% assurance that everything will turn out right. People without guts will shy away to new opportunities for innovation in offering products and services. The Filipino term **“Bahala na”** exemplifies this trait. This term projects optimism and not fatalism as this “Bahala na” is often followed by “remedy” (improvisations) along the way. While giving their best, Filipinos also use the popular phrase “nasa Diyos and awa, nasa tao ang gawa” (look to God for compassion and to man for action).

Moreover, **gaya-gaya (copycat)** is also attributed to Filipinos. This trait however is also helpful for Filipino entrepreneurs as this is the easiest way to prepare and train an entrepreneur. When a person is copying the best practice of others, he gains more confidence or *lakas ng loob* and continue the journey of entrepreneurship.

Furthermore, the Filipino trait **pakikipagsapalaran (sense of adventure)** and close family ties add to this risk-taking tendency of Filipinos. The sense of adventure drives them to pursue innovative undertakings and the knowledge that their family will support them boosts their confidence.

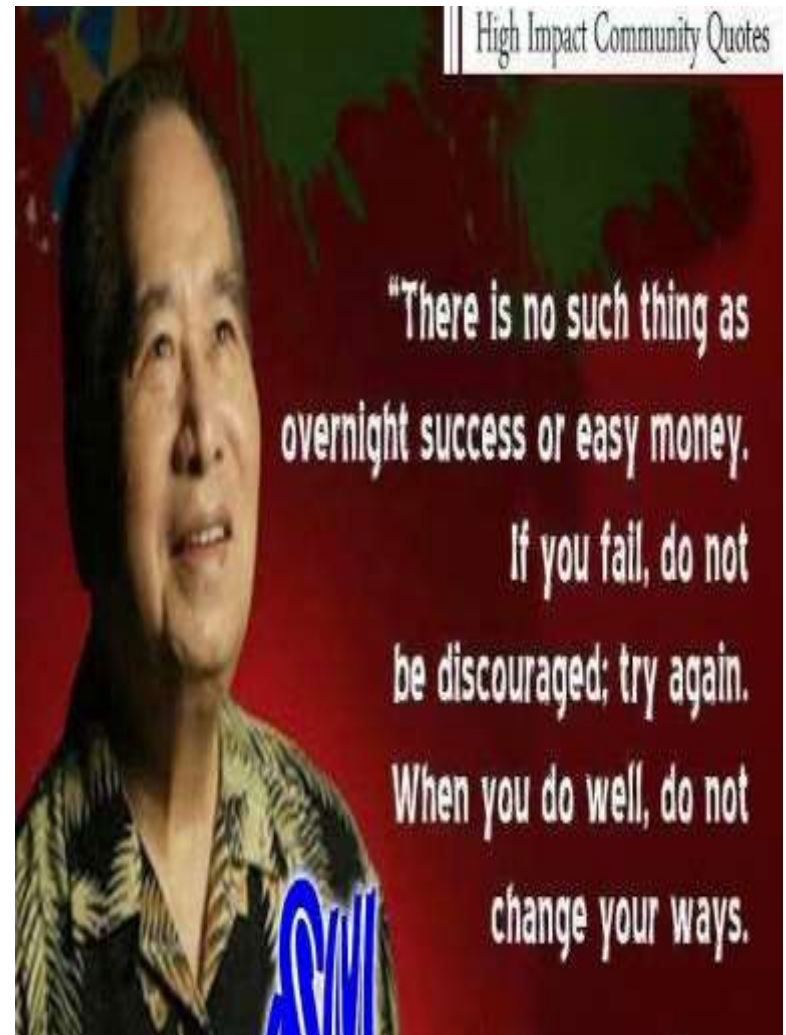


3. Katapatan (*Sincerity*). The strong spiritual and moral values evident among Filipinos demands us to be honest in our different dealings. This trait moves the Filipino entrepreneur to avoid dishonest and exploitative ways.

Moreover, this trait also promotes smooth labor-management relations. The entrepreneur offers fair salary and expects a good and honest service from his employees. On the other hand, the employees also render his honest service and expects fair treatment.



4. Social Mobility. Social Mobility means “the degree of difficulty or easiness a society or group of people allows a member to go up or climb one social level to another”. Filipinos love rags-to-riches stories and get inspired by stories of people with humble beginnings. This trait breeds entrepreneurial dreams and talents.



5. Sipag (*deligence*), Katipiran (*thrift or frugality*), Pagkamatiisin (*patient, with endurance*) and Pagtitimpi (*self-control*).

- While Filipinos often hear the stories of “Juan Tamad” (Lazy John), Filipinos also have ways to deal with the followers of Juan. Filipinos have the saying “Ang kasipaga’y kapatid ng kayamanan” (Industry is the twin of prosperity) and “Ang tamad namamatay sa gutom” (The lazy man starves to death).
- Moreover, the “katipiran” (thrift or frugality) among Filipinos is also exemplified in the popular saying “Kung may sinuksuok, may madudukot” (Put aside something today and tomorrow you’ll have something to draw from”.
- In addition, Filipinos are also known for their enduring trait. Most work hard for the promise of giving their families a better life.
- Lastly, Filipinos are known to have good tolerance. This is good as entrepreneurs face challenges in emotional and physical pressure of the business undertaking (SERDEF, 2007).





Any Questions....

